Eskwell, Dunrath and Quarrin had the highest establishment birth rates in 2026

Formation County designation for the 2027 to 2029 grant period

To	Secretary of Commerce
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From	Kristy Townsend, Business Dynamics Economist
Date	4 June 2027
Basis	Guideline FC-G-2027-01; UI register and reports as extracted 14 May 2027

Recommendation

Designate Eskwell, Dunrath and Quarrin as Formation Counties for 2027 to 2029. They had the highest establishment birth rates in 2026: Eskwell 11.3, Dunrath 9.8 and Quarrin 9.5 births per 100 establishments. Caldmere is the first county left out at 7.8, 1.7 below Quarrin, and would be designated if one of the three declines.

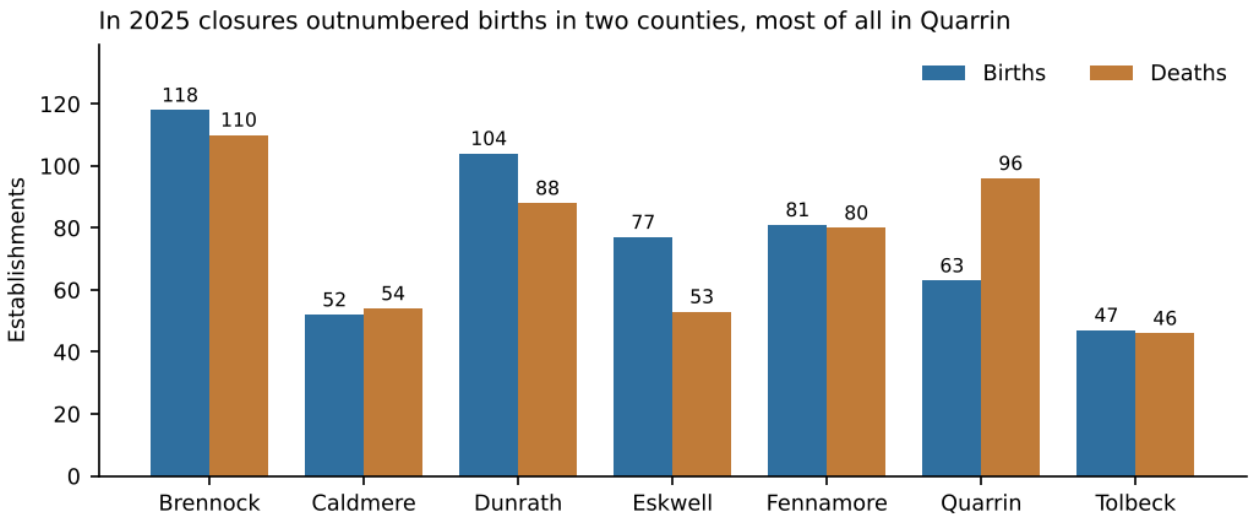
2026 establishment births by county

County	New accounts first employing in 2026	Set aside: business operated before	Births	Establishments employing, 2025 Q4	Birth rate per 100
Eskwell (designate)	**98**	**12**	**86**	**759**	**11.3**
Dunrath (designate)	**135**	**14**	**121**	**1,236**	**9.8**
Quarrin (designate)	**90**	**8**	**82**	**863**	**9.5**
Caldmere	84	29	55	702	7.8
Tolbeck	71	27	44	612	7.2
Brennock	136	23	113	1,618	7.0
Fennamore	88	15	73	1,104	6.6

Source: UI employer register, quarterly contribution reports and wage reports as extracted 14 May 2027; definitions and base per guideline FC-G-2027-01. Rates are compared unrounded and shown to one decimal. Accounts opened in 2026 that had not reported employment by the extract are not counted.

A birth is an establishment that first reported employment in 2026 and whose business did not operate before under another employer account (guideline 3.3). Of the 702 new employer accounts that first reported employment in 2026, 56 continue a business the register records as their predecessor and 72 continue a business the register does not link: most of the staff an account paid in its last quarter with employment went on together on the new account's first payroll, the old account reporting no employment after, as when a buyer re-registers a business it took over or a business re-registers where it moves. Many of those new owners hired from the first day, so the old staff are a minority of the new payroll: Caldmere's set-aside accounts include nineteen fuel and convenience stores re-registered by their buyer in April 2026, most of them reopened as markets with more than twice the staff, and Tolbeck's include businesses that moved into larger premises in its enterprise park from the other counties. New businesses started by former workers of a large employer that closed, as in Quarrin after a distribution warehouse shut in December 2025, took a handful of its staff and are births, as are the new businesses that opened in premises a closed business had left, most of them in Quarrin.

2025 for comparison



Births by the same definition for 2025. A death is an establishment whose last month with employment fell in 2025, that reported none in 2026 and whose business did not go on under another account: not the closures whose staff went on together under another account, new or established, as when an established employer of the same trade took a business on. Rates per 100 establishments employing in the fourth quarter of 2024 are in the workbook lornock_establishment_births_2026.xlsx, with every 2026 new account.